

WHY CAN'T WE SAVE OURSELVES?

Why Effort, Religion, and Good Intentions Cannot Bring Us Home

Human effort cannot erase guilt, overthrow death, restore fellowship, or create the life that only God can give.



BIG IDEA

Salvation must accomplish what human goodness, effort, and religion cannot do.

KEY SCRIPTURE

Ephesians 2:1-10

Romans 3:19-28

MEMORY VERSE

Ephesians 2:8-9 "For by grace are ye saved through faith... Not of works, lest any man should boast."

4 FOUR THINGS WE CANNOT DO

1 GUILT

Good deeds cannot make past rebellion untrue.

2 DEATH

Mortal life cannot produce resurrection life.

3 FELLOWSHIP

Religion cannot declare the relationship restored.

4 LIFE

No person can cause his own new birth.

GRACE

God acts for those who cannot rescue themselves.

FOUR TRUTHS TO REMEMBER

1 WORKS CANNOT ERASE GUILT

Improvement cannot rewrite the truth about rebellion.

2 RELIGION CANNOT GIVE LIFE

Christian proximity is not the same as union with Christ.

3 GRACE MEANS GOD ACTS

Salvation begins with what God does for the helpless.

4 GOOD WORKS ARE FRUIT

God creates new life for the good works that follow.

? THINK ABOUT IT

1 What am I tempted to trust instead of God's grace?

2 Which impossible task can my goodness or religion not solve?

3 Do I treat good works as the root of salvation or its fruit?

! THIS WEEK

Notice when you treat salvation as a project. Name the task you cannot accomplish and ask what grace means there.

+ YOU MAY TALK WITH US

If you have trusted your goodness, religion, baptism, or effort, a leader will privately show you what Scripture means by grace and faith.

SALVATION IS NOT SELF-IMPROVEMENT.

GOD MUST DO WHAT THE LOST CANNOT DO.